



TITOgraphy: When Order Takes Shape

Chi Dinh, Yifan Jing, Emma Yicheng Lou, Shaotian Sun, Owen (Yuxuan) Wu

Mentors: Grant Barkley, Mia Smith

University of Michigan, Department of Mathematics

ABSTRACT

Definition (Partial Order). A partially ordered set is set P together with a relation $\preceq$ on P that satisfies the following axioms:

1. $a \preceq a$, $\forall a \in P$ (reflexivity).
2. For all $a, b \in P$, if $a \preceq b$ and $b \preceq a$, then $a = b$ (antisymmetry).
3. For all $a, b, c \in P$, if $a \preceq b$ and $b \preceq c$, then $a \preceq c$ (transitivity).

Definition (Total Order). Partial order $\preceq$ is a **total order** if for all $a, b \in P$, $a \preceq b$ or $b \preceq a$.

Definition (TITO). Fix $n \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$. A translation-invariant total order (TITO) is a total order $\preceq$ on $\mathbb{Z}$ such that for all $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}$, $a \preceq b$ if and only if $a + n \preceq b + n$.

OBJECTIVE:

- Developing an algorithm to compare TITOs provides a concrete and computational way to study and visualize this structure.
- Implementing a comparator that outputs TITOs' relations and generates visualization.

The main goal of our project is to design and implement a Python package to compute TITO normalization, comparison, join and local Hasse diagrams.

THEORETICAL BACKGROUND

Definition (Block). A block of $(\preceq)$ is a subset I of $\mathbb{Z}$ such that the ordering of I by $(\preceq)$ has no minimal or maximal element, and for any $a, c \in I$, the interval $\{b \mid a \preceq b \preceq c\} \subset I$ is finite.

Definition (Waxing/Waning). Block I is **waxing** if $x \preceq x + n$ for all $x \in I$. I is **waning** if $x + n \preceq x$ for all $x \in I$.

Definition (Join). Least upper bound of 2 elements in the poset $WO(TTot_n)$.

Definition (Inversion). An inversion of a TITO $(\prec)$ is a reflection index (a, b) with $b \prec a$. Denote the set of inversions of $(\prec)$ by $N(\prec)$.

Definition (Weak Order). $(\prec_1) \leq (\prec_2)$ if and only if $N(\prec_1) \subseteq N(\prec_2)$.

Example: (n=3)

$\dots 4 \preceq 1 \preceq -2 \preceq -5 \dots -3 \preceq 2 \preceq 0 \preceq 5 \preceq 3 \preceq 8 \dots$

Blocks:

1. $[\dots 4 \preceq 1 \preceq -2 \preceq -5 \dots] \implies$ window: $[1]$
2. $[\dots 2 \preceq 0 \preceq 5 \preceq 3 \dots] \implies$ window: $[2, 0]$

Window notation: $[1][2, 0]$

COMPARISON ALGORITHM

Main idea: decompose the inversion set of a TITO into disjoint subsets, and find comparable finite representations for each component.

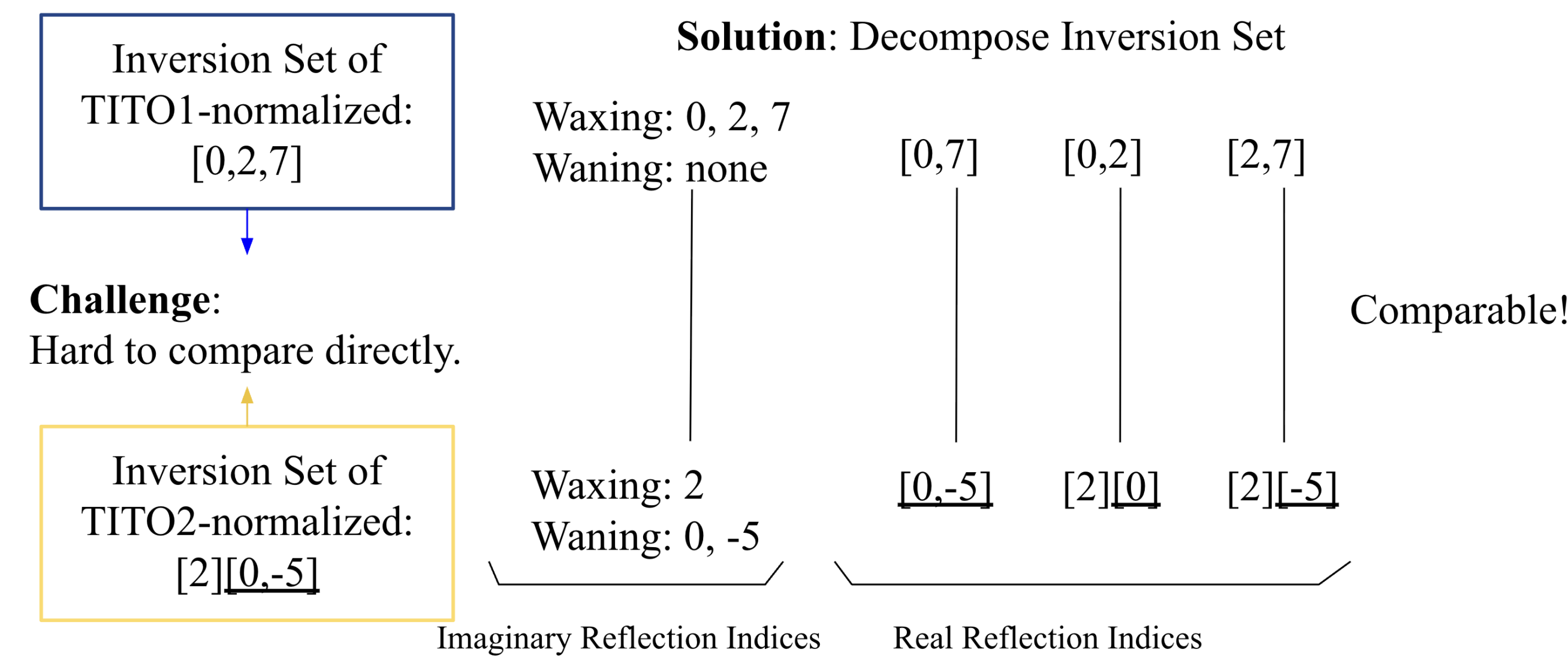


Figure 1: Main idea behind the comparison algorithm. Here $n = 3$.

NORMALIZATION ALGORITHM: One important pre-processing step in our algorithm is to normalize the window notation so that the following conditions are satisfied:

1. Within each window, the smallest residue class is always at the start.
2. Within each window, the first number is always between 0 and $n - 1$. This provides a unique normalized window notation for each TITO.

Imaginary Reflection Indices: Imaginary reflection indices come from determining, for each residue class, whether it lies in a waxing block or a waning block.

Real Reflection Indices: Real reflection indices come from comparing each pair of residue classes, which can be summarized in the following 6 cases:

Type	Block Normalized Format	Example	Inversion Representation	Inversion Size
Case 1	$[i][j], i < j$	$[0][1]$	$\{(-2, 0), (-5, 0), \dots\}$	Infinite
Case 2	$[i][j], i > j$	$[1][0]$	$\{(0, 1), (0, 4), \dots\}$	Infinite
Case 3	$[i, j], i < j$	$[0, 7]$	$\{(0, 1), (0, 4)\}$	Finite
Case 4	$[i, j], i > j$	$[0, -2]$	$\{(-2, 0)\}$	Finite
Case 5	$[i, j], i < j$	$[0, 4]$	complement of $\{(0, 1), (0, 4)\}$	Cofinite
Case 6	$[i, j], i > j$	$[0, -5]$	complement of $\{(-2, 0)\}$	Cofinite

Table 1: Description of inversions generated by two residue classes in each case.

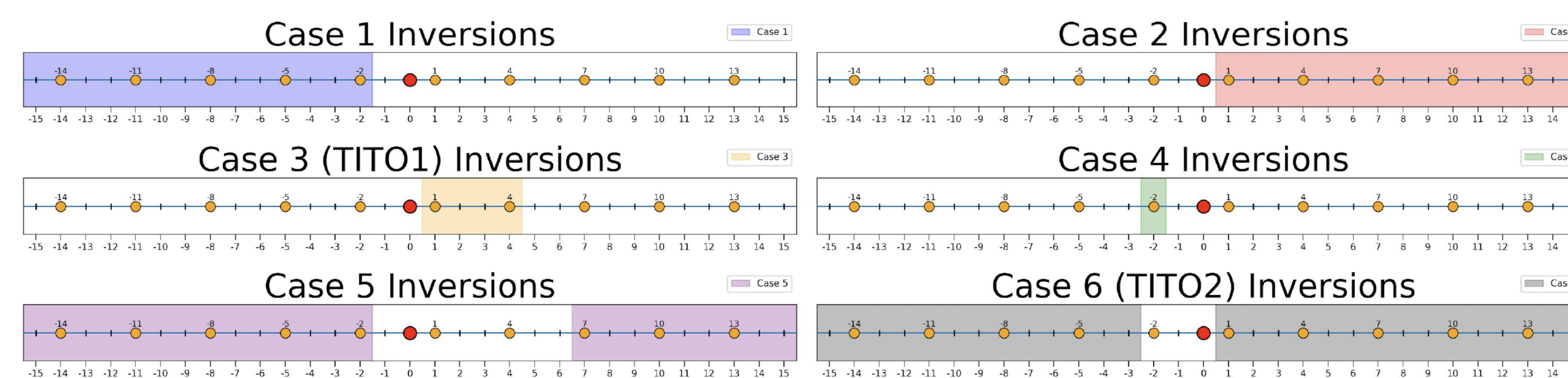


Figure 2: Inversions generated by two residue classes.

DIAGRAMS

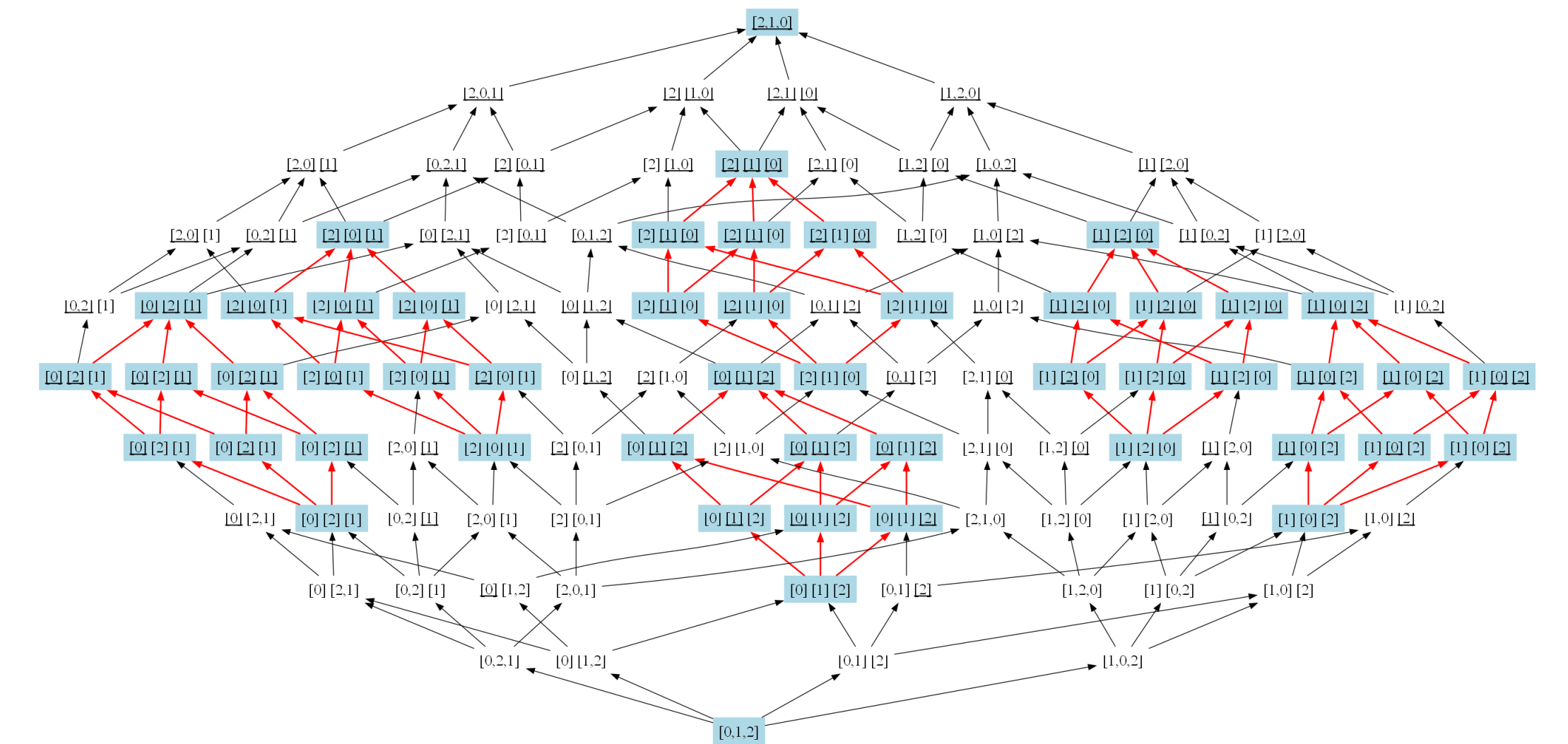
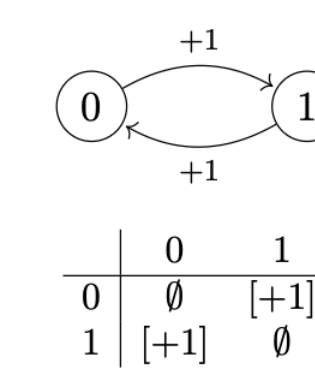
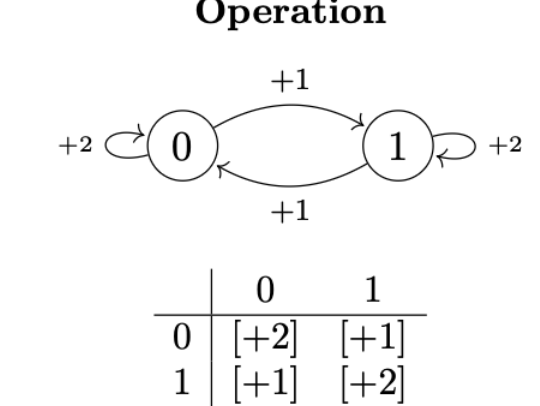


Figure 4: Hasse Diagram for $n = 3$ with elements 0, 1, 2.

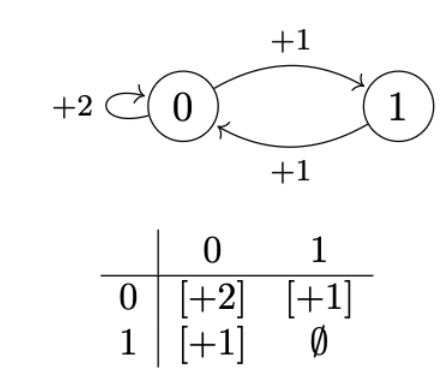
Step 0: Initialization



Step 2: Second Transitive Operation



Step 1: First Transitive Operation



Final

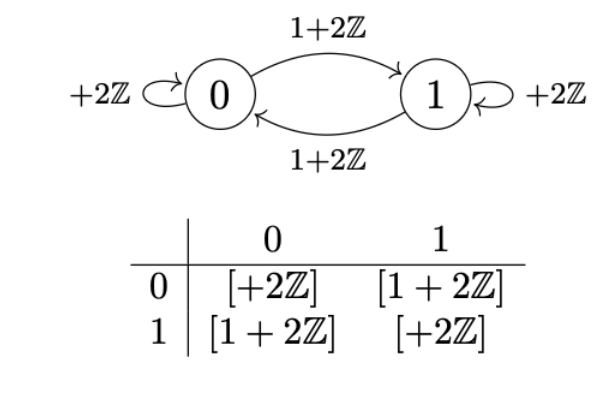


Figure 5: Demonstration of finding the join of TITOs $[1, 0]$ and $[2, 1]$ with $n = 2$.

CONCLUSION

We can use a finite representation for the infinite structure of the inversion set of TITO. We have accomplished a Python package:

- Normalizing a given TITO;
- Comparing given TITOs in weak order;
- Computing the join of two TITOs;
- Generating Hasse diagrams for small order-ideals of TITOs.

REFERENCES

- [1] Grant T. Barkley. *Extended weak order for the affine symmetric group*. Preprint 2025.
- [2] Grant T. Barkley. *Translation-invariant total orders and torsion classes*, Séminaire Lotharingien de Combinatoire, (2025)
- [3] Anders Björner and Francesco Brenti. *Combinatorics of Coxeter Groups* *Graduate Texts in Mathematics*, vol. 231, 2005.
- [4] Nathan Reading. *Cambrian Lattices*. *Advances in Mathematics* vol. 205, pg 313-353, 2006.
- [5] Matthew Dyer. *Hecke algebras and shellings of Bruhat intervals*. *Compositio Mathematica* vol. 89, pg 91-115, 1993.

Thank you, Grant T. Barkley and Mia Smith, for supporting our research project.